Live

GDP grew 0.2pc in Q1, missing forecasts; CBA eyes $180



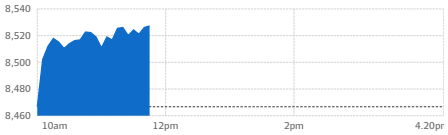
Nicola Blackburn

Updated Jun 4, 2025 – 11.41am, first published at 4.54am

Market indices

S&P/ASX 200 All Ords

S&P/ASX 200 8,527.30 ▲ +58.4 (0.69%)



Updated Jun 4, 2025 – 11.46am. Data is 20 mins delayed.

KEY POSTS

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GDP grew 0.2 per cent in Q1, below forecast

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Uranium stocks surge as Meta dials up nuclear power

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ASX eyes record; IDP pares losses

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Chinese construction slowdown could affect iron ore price: CBA

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GDP grew 0.2 per cent in Q1, below forecast

Cecile Lefort | Share post

The number: Australia's gross domestic product grew at 0.2 per cent in the March quarter, following a 0.6 per cent expansion in the previous three-month period. That was below forecasts of a 0.4 per cent rise. Annual growth stalled at 1.3 per cent.

Why it matters: The Reserve Bank cut the cash rate last month for the second time this year as inflation finally returned to target amid heightened uncertainty from the White House's trade policies and their impact on global

growth.

What has changed: There are concerns that the United States' aggressive tariffs could derail the global economy. The Australian economy is running at a pedestrian pace compared to its historical trend.

What next: US employment data will be released overnight and the Bank of Canada is expected to cut its benchmark by a quarter of one percentage point to 2.5 per cent.

48 mins ago – 11.01AM

Uranium stocks surge as Meta dials up nuclear power

Nicola Blackburn | Share post

Uranium stocks jumped at the open following news that one of the world's biggest technology companies had stepped up demand for nuclear power.

Paladin Energy was the S&P/ASX 200 Index's second-best performing stock near 11am, rising 6.4 per cent. Deep Yellow was up 4.9 per cent and Boss Energy by 4.8 per cent.

The rise came after Meta overnight signed a 20-year contract to buy 1121 megawatts from Constellation's nuclear plant in Illinois, with power supply beginning in 2027. This follows similar deals struck by peers Microsoft, Amazon, and Google parent Alphabet.

Nuclear power has emerged as one of the biggest winners from the AI-fuelled surge in electricity needed for data centres. New nuclear reactors are an important source of uranium demand growth.

1 hr ago – 10.39AM

CBA resets record, shares near $180

Nicola Blackburn | Share post

Commonwealth Bank surged to a fresh record on Wednesday at the open as risk-on sentiment swept across the bourse.

The shares hit a fresh all-time high of $179.20 at the open. That brings its year-to-date gain to 17 per cent, ahead of the ASX 200 financial sector's 7.9 per cent advance.

The ASX 200 rose 0.6 per cent in the first 40 minutes of trade, nearing its all-time high.

1 hr ago – 10.06AM

ASX eyes record; IDP pares losses

Nicola Blackburn | Share post

Australian shares rose in line with an advance in US stocks after fresh economic data provided some reassurance the American jobs market was holding steady amid President Donald Trump's trade war.

The S&P/ASX 200 Index edged up 0.5 per cent, or by 40.5 points, to 8507.2 within the first 20 minutes of trade. All 11 sectors were pointing higher, led by energy. The All Ordinaries was up 0.5 per cent.

In New York, the S&P 500 Index came just 2.8 per cent shy of its all-time high hit earlier this year after US job openings rose unexpectedly in April from 7.2 million to around 7.4 million. US futures pointed modestly higher, predicting equities would hold gains. Chipmakers helped pace gains with Broadcom hitting a fresh record high and Nvidia advancing 2.8 per cent.

The Australian sharemarket was a sea of green with energy and mining stocks recording the strongest gains. Miners were boosted by a more than 1 per cent advance in Singaporean iron ore futures, with **BHP** and **Fortescue** both up 1 per cent.

Aluminium stocks **Alcoa** and **South32** climbed 4.1 per cent and 1 per cent respectively after Trump pressed ahead with an executive order to hike tariffs on aluminium and steel imports to 50 per cent.

Oil stocks were strong, with **Woodside** up 2.2 per cent and **Santos** up 1 per cent, after crude gained more than 1 per cent overnight, driven by bushfires in Canada stalling output. Uranium stocks also surged after Meta became the latest major US tech stock to step up nuclear power usage.

Paladin Energy was the S&P/ASX 200 Index's second-best performing stock near 11am, rising 6.4 per cent, Deep Yellow was up 4.9 per cent and Boss Energy by 4.8 per cent.

Stocks on the move

IDP Education bounced back after the previous session's almost 50 per cent drop, rising 6.7 per cent. The company warned on Tuesday that global immigration policy uncertainty had hurt its enrolment pipeline.

Westpac lifted 0.7 per cent despite an ASIC decision to sue its subsidiary RAMS for alleged systemic misconduct.

Mayne Pharma jumped 4.7 per cent after informing investors it had received a "close out letter" from a US regulator confirming it had "addressed the issues identified" about its contraceptive pill Nextstellis.

Japanese entertainment giant Mixi has lobbed a higher bid to buy **PointsBet** and stave off a takeover by Australian bookmaker **Betr**, prompting a 9.7 per cent leap in PointsBet shares. Betr retreated 4.2 per cent.

3 hrs ago – 9.42AM

Mayne Pharma says Cosette may still revoke bid

Nicola Blackburn, Michael Smith

Share post

Mayne Pharma has warned shareholders it may still receive a proposal from suitor Cosette abandoning its $672 million takeover bid of the pharmaceutical company despite a 10-day notice period having passed.

Mayne admitted last month private equity-backed Cosette was reviewing the deal because it thought there had been a "material adverse change" in the company's financial performance since it made its offer in February. Cosette said it had taken issue with Mayne Pharma's last trading update and a letter from the US Food and Drug Administration accusing Mayne of making misleading claims about its contraceptive pill, Nextstellis.

In a notice to investors on Wednesday, Mayne said it had not received any termination notice from its US suitor but warned the expiry date "did not prevent Cosette from issuing a notice of termination". It said it would advise the market if such a notice is received.

The pharmaceutical giant also said it had received a "close-out letter" from the US regulator that confirmed Mayne Pharma had "addressed the issues identified" about Nextstellis.

3 hrs ago – 9.36AM

Chinese construction slowdown could affect iron ore price: CBA

Gus McCubbing | Share post

A slowdown in China's property construction could weigh on iron ore and coking coal prices in the short term, according to Commonwealth Bank mining and energy commodities strategist Vivek Dhar.

Manufacturing data released yesterday showed that any uptick in infrastructure construction had been offset by a fall in property construction, Dhar wrote in a note released on Wednesday morning.

"The deterioration in both the official manufacturing (purchasers' managing index) and the construction activity index underscores the additional support China's economy needs if China is still committed to achieving 'around 5 per cent' growth this year."

"We continue to believe that China's commodity demand impulse will continue to weaken until meaningful stimulus is announced in early H2 2025," he wrote. "This will likely weigh on near-term iron ore and coking coal prices the most. Any decline in base metal prices from weaker Chinese demand will likely need the US dollar to stop sliding."

3 hrs ago – 9.31AM

Bondholders probe Soul Patts over Brickworks merger

Nicola Blackburn | Share post

The owners of $450 million worth of convertible bonds issued by Soul Patts

have questioned the company over the implications for bondholders, including conversion and redemption rights.

In a notice to investors, the company said it had fielded questions regarding what if any “change of control” period would be for the purpose of conversion rights, and when a redemption notice would be issued.

Soul Patts said a change of control period would last for 30 business days, and it would notify bondholders within 10 business days of a “relevant event” occurring.

“If and when a relevant event occurs, the holder of each note would have the right, at such holder’s option, to redeem some or all of the holders’ notes ... not later than 70 days following the relevant event or, if later, 70 days following the date upon which notice thereof is given to noteholders.”

3 hrs ago – 9.13AM

Mark McInnes scores $2m pay day from Lovisa

Carrie LaFrenz | Share post

Retailer Mark McInnes has scored another $2 million in annual salary after becoming executive deputy chairman of fast fashion jewellery chain Lovisa.

McInnes joined Blundy’s private investment firm BB Retail Capital in January 2024, where he oversaw all of its global retail and consumer businesses after working for billionaire Solomon Lew at Premier Investments for a decade. Cheston also worked for Premier Investments as head of its Smiggle kids stationery brand.

BBRC controls 39 per cent of the issued capital of Lovisa and Blundy is the

chairman. He said McInnes' extensive experience and successful track record in large Australian ASX-listed retailers, combined with his leadership skills, make him "an invaluable member of the board and executive management team".

John Cheston starts today as global chief executive of the Brett Blundy-backed retailer, taking over from Victor Herrero.

The board is also considering the appointment of a new independent non-executive director.

3 hrs ago – 9.11AM

James Hardie prices $1.7b debt to fund Azek takeover

Nicola Blackburn | Share post

James Hardie has revealed the pricing of $1.7 billion in senior secured debt to be issued to help fund its $14 billion takeover of US outdoor decking group Azek.

In a proposed private offering, the company will issue $700 million worth of senior secured notes with an interest rate of 5.875 per cent, due in 2031. The remaining $1 billion worth of notes will reach maturity in 2032 and carry an interest rate of 6.125 per cent.

4 hrs ago – 8.46AM

Japan's Mixi hikes PointsBet takeover bid

Zoe Samios | Share post

Japanese entertainment giant Mixi has lobbed a higher bid to buy PointsBet and stave off a takeover of the business by local bookmaker Betr.

PointsBet has been in due diligence

with Matthew Tripp's Betr since May when the latter bought almost 20 per cent of the former and pitched a $360 million takeover proposal comprised of cash and scrip.

Betr's attempts to buy the business copped a curveball late on Tuesday after PointsBet revealed it had received an improved takeover offer from Mixi, which values the business at $402 million, up from a $353 million offer made in late February.

Read more.

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